2 Types of Diseases

There are four main types of diseases. They are:

- Infectious diseases
- Hereditary diseases
- Physiological diseases
- Deficiency diseases



Do you know?

More number of people die every year due to heart disease than any other diseases.

a. Infectious diseases

Infectious diseases are caused by microorganisms which invade our body and multiply inside them. These diseases are spread from one person to another. E.g. Common cold.

b. Hereditary diseases

Hereditary diseases occur due to abnormalities in the gene. These diseases are passed from parents to children. E.g. Heart disease.

c. Physiological diseases

Diseases which are caused due to malfunction of the body organs are called physiological diseases. E.g. Asthma.

d. Deficiency diseases

A diet which contains all essential nutrients in correct proportion is indispensable for maintaining good health. Deficiency in one or more of the nutrients causes various diseases. These are called deficiency diseases.

❖ Protein deficiency diseases

Marasmus and Kwashiorkor are the protein deficiency diseases. In marasmus, the child loses weight and it will appear as though bones are covered by skin. In Kwashiorkor, the child develops an enlarged belly with swollen face and feet. By eating protein rich foods like egg, milk, fish and green leafy vegetables we can avoid protein deficiency diseases.



Do you know?

Kwashiorkor disease is found more among people in developing countries. It is because their diet is high in carbohydrates which is cheaper and low in proteins. As they live below poverty line, they couldn't afford protein rich food which is costly.





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